

I tell you, in the 15 years or so I've been Barefoot I've never had anyone come back to me and say:

'Mister Barefoot, the worst thing I *ever* did was follow your advice and pay off my credit card. I totally regret that.'

Never. *Ever*.

That's because credit cards are a total rip-off.

However, the banks are actively targeting your teens, trying to sign them up.

The banks understand that for most people a credit card is like buying a puppy. Once you get it, you're very unlikely to give it up. It can bite you, pee all over your couch, dump a turd in the middle of your lounge room, and you'll still keep it.

And that's exactly why we're going to make sure your kids never get one in the first place.

I'm not going to take a backward step—I'm going to fight dirty. Seriously, your kids' financial confidence is at stake.

The sixth challenge of the Barefoot Ten is for your teen to **'promise to never, ever get a credit card'**, and by the time you've finished this chapter your kids will see not having a credit card as a *reverse status symbol*.

They're so smart they don't need one.

As we go, you'll also discover:

- whether your teen needs a credit card to build up their 'credit rating'
- the 'credit smoothie' that your teens will love.

This Money Meal is one your kids will remember forever.

But let's kick things off by considering the true story of a well-meaning father who got it very, very wrong.

'Daddy, give me 50 bucks'